



Field Communications Code Reference

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A compact code protocol for use when data connectivity is unavailable. Designed for truck drivers, hikers, and emergency services operating across borders or in remote terrain. Three user profiles share a common alert and system vocabulary — enabling cross-agency communication even under severely degraded conditions.

Sharing this reference is encouraged. Interoperability depends on all parties knowing the codes.

How the codes work

Each code is a **letter** (category) followed by **two digits** (severity or sub-type). Within each category, lower numbers mean *normal or minor*, higher numbers mean *serious or critical*. The 99 code is always the most severe.

A 1 1

└─── Severity 11 = nominal → 99 = emergency
└─── Category letter

Multiple codes can be combined in a single message. A free-text note can be appended for additional detail.



Driver

Truck / cross-border operator



Hiker

Outdoor / trekking team member



Emergency Services

SAR / paramedic / ranger / fire

Universal codes — all profiles



A (Alert) and Z (System) are identical across Driver, Hiker, and Emergency Services

A **Alert level**

CODE	MEANING
A11	All clear. Situation normal.
A22	Minor incident. Self-handling.
A33	Caution. Possible problem developing. Monitoring.
A44	Assistance needed. Non-urgent.
A55	Assistance needed urgently.
A66	Serious incident in progress.
A77	Critical situation. Multiple problems.
A88	Extreme danger.
A99	SOS. Life threatening emergency. Send help immediately.

CODE	MEANING
Z00	Heartbeat. No change.
Z01	Start of shift / hike / deployment.
Z02	End of shift / hike. Safely stood down.
Z03	Message acknowledged.
Z04	Message corrupted. Please resend.
Z05	Relay this message forward.
Z06	Relay this message back to base.
Z07	Base or command requesting status from all.
Z08	Requesting status from this specific contact.
Z09	Group or convoy disbanding.



Driver codes — prefix D

Truck operators, cross-border logistics, convoy drivers

B

 Border

CODE	MEANING
B11	Approaching border. Within twenty kilometres.
B22	In queue at border post. Normal wait.
B33	Delayed at border. Paperwork issue.
B44	Goods inspection ordered.
B55	Unofficial payment demanded.
B66	Goods seized by authorities.
B77	Vehicle impounded.
B88	Driver detained.
B99	Refused entry. Turned back.

C

 Cargo

CODE	MEANING
C11	Cargo loaded. All secure. Normal.
C22	Partial load or minor shift.
C33	Load shifted. Stopping to re-secure.
C44	Cargo damaged.
C55	Spillage or items fallen from vehicle.
C66	Cargo partially stolen.
C77	All cargo stolen or seized.
C88	Hazmat or cold-chain incident.
C99	Total cargo loss.



Driver status

CODE	MEANING
D11	Driver on duty. Driving normally.
D22	Driver on a stop. Fuel, meal, or break.
D33	Driver loading or unloading cargo.
D44	Driver waiting. Customs, checkpoint, or traffic.
D55	Driver delayed. Problem. Cannot proceed yet.
D66	Driver feeling unwell or fatigued.
D77	Driver detained or facing legal issue.
D88	Driver breakdown. Cannot continue without help.
D99	Driver emergency. Driver in danger.



Vehicle fault

CODE	MEANING
E11	Engine warning light. Minor. Continuing.
E22	Single flat tyre. Changing now.
E33	Multiple flat tyres. Cannot change.
E44	Engine overheating. Pulled over.
E55	Mechanical breakdown. Non-engine.
E66	Complete engine failure.
E77	Fire.
E88	Accident damage. Vehicle cannot move.
E99	Vehicle write-off. Total loss.



Fuel

CODE	MEANING
F11	Fuel tank full.
F22	Fuel three-quarter.
F33	Fuel half.
F44	Fuel quarter.
F55	Fuel low. Need refuel within 50 km.
F66	Fuel critical. Need refuel now.
F77	Running on jerry cans or reserve tank.
F88	Fuel contaminated or wrong fuel used.
F99	No fuel. Stopped.

G Convoy

CODE	MEANING
G11	Solo vehicle. No convoy.
G22	Convoy lead vehicle.
G33	Convoy mid position.
G44	Convoy tail vehicle.
G55	Convoy intact. All trucks present.
G66	One vehicle missing from convoy.
G77	Multiple vehicles missing.
G88	Convoy separated. Regroup at next waypoint.
G99	Convoy disbanded.

H Help needed

CODE	MEANING
H11	Need fuel delivered to my location.
H22	Need mechanic or mobile workshop.
H33	Need medical assistance or ambulance.
H44	Need police or official escort.
H55	Need recovery truck or crane.
H66	Need food, water, or supplies.
H77	Need customs agent or documentation help.
H88	Need armed escort.
H99	Major incident. All assistance needed urgently.

J Journey progress

CODE	MEANING
J11	Journey started. Departed on schedule.
J22	25% of route complete.
J33	Halfway. 50% complete.
J44	75% complete.
J55	Approaching destination. Under 10 km.
J66	Arrived at destination.
J77	Route significantly extended. Major detour.
J88	Turned back. Retracing route.
J99	Lost. Off route entirely.

K Communications

CODE	MEANING
K11	Full communications. All normal.
K22	Data only. No voice calls.
K33	SMS only. No data or voice.
K44	Voice only. No data or SMS.
K55	Radio contact only.
K66	Satellite communications active.
K77	Mesh WiFi only. No cellular.
K88	This message relayed via another device.
K99	No communications. Sent via third party.

R Road conditions

CODE	MEANING
R11	Good tarmac road.
R22	Tarmac with potholes.
R33	Gravel or dirt road. Passable.
R44	Rough track. Mud or poor surface.
R55	Road partially blocked.
R66	Road closed or one-lane obstruction.
R77	Bridge out or dangerous.
R88	Road impassable.
R99	No route. Off road or completely lost.

S Security

CODE	MEANING
S11	Situation normal. No threats.
S22	General caution in area.
S33	Unofficial checkpoint or vehicle following.
S44	Criminal roadblock reported ahead.
S55	Bribe demanded.
S66	Robbery attempt. Repelled.
S77	Robbery in progress.
S88	Armed attack on convoy.
S99	Hijack or kidnap.

T Schedule

CODE	MEANING
T11	On time. On schedule.
T22	Slightly delayed. Under one hour.
T33	Delayed one to two hours.
T44	Delayed two to four hours.
T55	Delayed four to eight hours.
T66	Delayed one day.
T77	Major delay. ETA unknown.
T88	Schedule abandoned.
T99	Trip aborted. Returning.

V Vehicle movement

CODE	MEANING
V11	Vehicle parked. Stopped safely.
V22	Vehicle moving normally.
V33	Vehicle moving slowly. Under 20 km/h.
V44	Vehicle stuck. Mud, sand, or ditch.
V55	Towing another vehicle.
V66	Being towed.
V77	Vehicle overturned.
V88	Accident. Vehicle cannot move.
V99	Write-off. Total loss.

W Weather

CODE	MEANING
W11	Clear and dry. Good visibility.
W22	Light rain or haze.
W33	Heavy rain.
W44	Thunderstorm or high wind.
W55	Fog or poor visibility.
W66	Flood. Road wet but passable.
W77	Flood. Road impassable.
W88	Dust storm or harmattan. Near zero visibility.
W99	Extreme weather conditions. Stopped.



Hiker codes — prefix H

Trekkers, outdoor teams, wilderness expeditions

H



Help needed

CODE	MEANING
H11	Need food or water.
H22	Need first aid or medical kit.
H33	Need medical assistance or evacuation assessment.
H44	Need rescue team.
H55	Need helicopter or air evacuation.
H66	Need search and rescue.
H77	Need shelter or emergency bivouac.
H88	Need urgent evacuation. Cannot walk.
H99	Major emergency. All assistance needed immediately.

T



Trail conditions

CODE	MEANING
T11	Good trail. Well marked. Easy going.
T22	Trail intermittent or overgrown.
T33	Trail lost. Navigating by GPS or compass.
T44	Off trail. Open terrain. Navigable.
T55	Steep ascent. Slowing pace.
T66	Steep descent. Taking care.
T77	Technical terrain. Scramble, rock, or snow.
T88	Dangerous section. Crossing carefully.
T99	Terrain impassable. Forced to turn back.



Gear / equipment

CODE	MEANING
U11	All gear in good condition.
U22	Minor gear issue. Non-critical.
U33	Gear damaged but workaround found.
U44	Critical item failing. Tent, stove, or filter.
U55	Navigation equipment lost or failed.
U66	First aid kit in use.
U77	Emergency shelter needed. Setting up bivouac.
U88	Multiple critical gear failures.
U99	All essential gear lost. Catastrophic.



Vitals / group health

CODE	MEANING
V11	All group members fit and well.
V22	Minor fatigue or discomfort. Continuing.
V33	Blisters or minor injury. Slowing slightly.
V44	Injury. Significantly slower pace.
V55	Member cannot maintain normal pace.
V66	Serious injury. Stopped. Assessing evacuation.
V77	Member collapsed or unconscious.
V88	Medical emergency. Evacuation required.
V99	Life threatening. Emergency services needed immediately.



Scheduled check-in

CODE	MEANING
Y11	Scheduled check-in. All well. On route.
Y22	Check-in. Slight delay. Still safe.
Y33	Check-in. Significant delay. Still safe.
Y44	Off route but safe and navigating.
Y55	Missed previous check-in window. Now reporting.
Y66	Requesting acknowledgement from base.
Y77	Safe arrival at camp or planned waypoint.
Y88	Descending. Final leg to trailhead.
Y99	Multiple check-ins missed. Emergency alert triggered.



Security

CODE	MEANING
S11	Situation normal. No threats.
S22	General caution. Unfamiliar area.
S33	Suspicious activity nearby.
S44	Wildlife threat. Keeping distance.
S55	Wildlife encounter. Backing away.
S66	Aggressive wildlife. Retreating.
S77	Hostile people encountered.
S88	Threatened or followed. Moving to safety.
S99	Immediate danger from people or wildlife.



Emergency Services codes — prefix X

SAR, paramedics, fire crews, rangers — degraded-comms operations

Aligned with international emergency standards

The P (triage) category uses the international P1–P4 priority scale (P1=Immediate, P2=Delayed, P3=Minor, P4=Expectant). The I (incident) and N (count) categories reflect the METHANE major-incident declaration framework used by joint emergency services.



Incident type

CODE	MEANING
I11	Medical emergency. No scene hazard.
I22	Road traffic collision.
I33	Search and rescue. Missing person.
I44	Fire or structural incident.
I55	Flood or water rescue.
I66	Hazardous materials or chemical release.
I77	Structural collapse.
I88	Civil unrest, violence, or armed incident.
I99	Major incident declared.



Patient triage

CODE	MEANING
P11	No casualties on scene.
P22	Walking wounded only. P3 – minor.
P33	Serious but stable. P2 – delayed.
P44	Life-threatening casualties. P1 – immediate.
P55	Expectant casualties. P4 – palliative.
P66	Mixed triage. Multiple categories present.
P77	Mass casualty incident declared.
P88	Casualty count incomplete. Scene not cleared.
P99	Catastrophic. Multiple fatalities confirmed.

N**Number of casualties**

CODE	MEANING
N11	One casualty.
N22	Two to five casualties.
N33	Six to ten casualties.
N44	Eleven to twenty casualties.
N55	Twenty to fifty casualties.
N66	Fifty to one hundred casualties.
N77	Over one hundred casualties.
N88	Unknown number. Scene assessment ongoing.
N99	Casualties at multiple locations.

V**Patient vitals**

CODE	MEANING
V11	Conscious and alert. Talking normally.
V22	Conscious but confused or agitated.
V33	Responding to voice commands only.
V44	Responding to pain only. Unconscious.
V55	Unresponsive. Breathing present.
V66	Not breathing. CPR in progress.
V77	Severe haemorrhage. Tourniquet applied.
V88	Cardiac arrest.
V99	Deceased. Confirmed.

R**Resources on scene**

CODE	MEANING
R11	First aider only. No professional responder.
R22	Paramedic or advanced first aider on scene.
R33	Ambulance crew on scene.
R44	Fire crew on scene.
R55	Police on scene.
R66	Multiple emergency services on scene.
R77	Incident commander established.
R88	Field hospital or casualty clearing station active.
R99	All resources overwhelmed. Urgent reinforcement required.

H**Resources required**

CODE	MEANING
H11	No additional resources required.
H22	Additional ground ambulance required.
H33	Air ambulance or helicopter required.
H44	Fire and rescue required.
H55	Police or armed response required.
H66	HAZMAT or contamination team required.
H77	Heavy rescue or urban search team required.
H88	Military or specialist support required.
H99	Mass casualty response. All resources required.

E Evacuation status

CODE	MEANING
E11	No evacuation required. Treating on scene.
E22	Self-evacuation possible. Casualties walking to transport.
E33	Vehicle evacuation possible. Road is accessible.
E44	Stretcher evacuation required.
E55	Air evacuation required. Landing zone needed.
E66	Water or boat evacuation required.
E77	Technical rescue required. Rope or confined space.
E88	Evacuation route compromised. Seeking alternative.
E99	Evacuation impossible. Casualties sheltering in place.

S Scene safety

CODE	MEANING
S11	Scene safe. No hazards.
S22	Potential hazards present. Caution advised.
S33	Fire, chemical, or structural hazard on scene.
S44	Active threat. Scene not yet secure.
S55	Hostile persons on scene. Law enforcement required.
S66	Contamination hazard. Exclusion zone required.
S77	Scene partially cleared. Ongoing risk.
S88	Scene unsafe. Responders withdrawn.
S99	Immediate danger to responders. Evacuate scene now.

Quick reference – common situations

Same-meaning codes across the three profiles

Situation	Driver (D)	Hiker (H)	Emergency (X)
All clear / normal	A11	A11	A11
Need urgent help	A55 + H44	A55 + H44	A55 + H33
Life threat – SOS	A99 + H99	A99 + H99	A99 + H99
SMS-only comms	K33	K33	K33

Situation	Driver (D)	Hiker (H)	Emergency (X)
On schedule / en route	T11 / D11	Y11	J11
Arrived at destination	J66	J66	J66
Lost / off route	J99	J99	J99
Severe weather	W77–W99	W77–W99	W77–W99
Acknowledged	Z03	Z03	Z03
Corrupted message	Z04	Z04	Z04